Aya 3:7

Introduction

Salaamun Alaykum. There are some āyat in the Qur'an that are so significant and impactful that they affect so much of our understanding of the Qur'an. Āyah 3:7 is one of those āyah. Insha Allahh, in this segment, we will dive into the details of this āyah, and analyze the significant implications of its correct interpretation according to the Abrahamic locution and the Quranic methodology that we use on this channel.

أَعُوْذُ بِاللهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطٰانِ الرَّجِيْمِ بِسْمِ اللهِ الرَّحْمٰنِ الرَّحِيْمِ

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ رَبِّ اشْرَحْ لِي صَدْرِي وَيَسِّرْ لِي أَمْرِي وَاحْلُلْ عُقْدَةً مِنْ لِسَانِي يَفْقَهُوا قَوْلِي

The interpretation of āyah 3:7 is the subject of this segment. I promise you; this is extremely significant to everything that we need to do while we engage and interpret the Qur'an, and do the 'tadabbur' that Allahh (SWA) commanded us to do in the Qurʿān. In this segment, we will analyze the significant consequences of this āyah, and also get into two key concepts:

- الْحُكْم "Al-Ḥukm"
- الْحِكْمَةَ "Al-Ḥikmah"

Both of these terms have suffered significant disagreements in our tradition, and in our Islamic history. This is part of a series called: "Why no Stories Equal no Qurʿān." This is part 2.3. If you have not seen the earlier parts of the series, I highly encourage you to do so. The purpose of this series is to show you how we learn from the Qur'anic stories and parables, what is referred to in the Qur'an as a dhikr.

The proper interpretation of āyah 3:7 depends on so much of what we have covered already in the past few segments. In this segment, we will continue the discourse on dhikr, as we have mentioned. We will follow the Abrahamic locution that is extracted from dhikr. Āyah 3:7 is the basis of a pseudo-science called: "Muḥkam and Mutashābih". We will dive into this to decode it, and to understand exactly how reliable that pseudo-science is.

The details of "Al-Ḥukm" shall be presented according to the Qurʿān, and in accordance with the Abrahamic locution that Allahh (SWA) deposited in the Qurʿān. We will also get into a very significant concept called: أُمُّ الكِتَاب "Umm-ul Kitaab". Again, this is another concept that has suffered significant amount of disagreements among the scholars and the people who researched the Qurʿān in our Islamic history.

We will have a very important discussion regarding "Al-Ḥikmah". We will also have a number of gifts as usual, five gifts in this case, including a critical learning tool to help you learn the proper way to make DuƐāʿ 'to supplicate'. Please don't miss it. Stay with us until the end, it is really worth your time because the conclusion of this segment is something you definitely do not want to miss.

As with prior segments on this channel, we encourage you to watch the earlier parts of the series and other videos in this channel, because all of our videos build on prior segments. We introduce concepts, and then we build on them as we continuously go forward. This is an academic presentation, please do not underestimate the concepts. This is not for entertainment purposes.

We use the organic Qur'anic methodology, which is the methodology that is extracted from within the Qur'an itself. It guides us on how to engage the Qurʿān, and teaches us the boundaries, principles and the guidelines we need to keep us in check. We refer to it as the self-correcting methodology, in the sense that it helps correct any mistakes we may make in the process of the interpretation, so that we receive the guidance and understanding directly from Allahh (SWA).

We refer to the concept of nested interpretation. Again, we will use it in many different ways in this segment insha Allahh, as you will see. As we said earlier, we use the concept of the Abrahamic locution. This is the divine lexicon that Allahh (SWA) chose to use within the Qurʿān and in the dhikr, the stories and the parables. We mentioned several times before that this divine lexicon is significantly different than the dictionaries of the Arab poets of the seventh century. And you will see again, how we will make clear distinctions in order to better understand the Qurʿān.

Finally, please do not make comments or ask questions in the comments stream unless you have seen the full video. Very often, the question you are asking about is included in the video itself, and we answer it in a direct way.

Reminders

A couple of reminders from prior segments, just in case you have not seen them.

Reminder 1: تَشَٰبَهَ and تَشَٰبَهَ عَلَيْنَا

تَشَٰبَهَ عَلَيْنَا is different than تَشَٰبَهَ

- تَشَٰبَهَ means: "to appear similar"
- تَشَٰبَهَ عَلَيْنَا means: "Its apparent similarity brings confusion upon us"

We saw the word تَشَٰبَهَ in a prior segment titled: "How to Circumcise a She Cow". Please refer to it if you don't know what that means. So those are two different expressions, two different terms. They don't mean the same thing.

Reminder 2: ٱلْبَيِّنَٰتِ "Al-Bay-yināt"

Another reminder regarding ٱلْبَيِّنَٰتِ "Al-Bay-yināt", which means "the instruments of deduction". In other words, the techniques for extracting evidence from the scripture, from the text of the Qurʿān itself, and to develop the understanding based on these "Bay-yināt". The Qurʿān is full of such "Bay-yināt". Almost every āyah gives us a clear indication on how to use the Qurʿān to learn how to extract meanings and

indications, and to be confident that what we're learning is in accordance with what Allahh (SWA) gave us in the Qurʿān.

Reminder 3: تَفْصِيلَ Tafṣeel "Syntactic Segmentation"

Another reminder is the concept that we're going to use extensively in this segment called: تَفْصِيلَ Tafṣeel "Syntactic Segmentation". What is that? That is interpreting sentences using different legitimate syntactic configurations. Wow, big words. Because we have no punctuation marks in the Qurʿān, we have to be very careful where we choose to put the comma, period, exclamation mark or a question mark, and how to interpret a certain particle, pronoun or preposition. Everything comes into play when we are making decisions on how to interpret a certain āyah, or a certain sentence. So, these choices result in a specific syntactic segmentation. Allahh (SWA) teaches us that this is called: تَفْصِيلَ Tafṣeel. It's breaking up the sentence into different legitimate syntactic clauses or blocks.

If you recall, from part 2.2 in this series, the segment that's called: "How to Circumcise a She Cow". We discussed āyah 2:71. This is a page from that segment.

فَذَبَحُوهَا وَمَا كَادُوا يَفْعَلُونَ ﴿2:71﴾

All interpreters and Translators assumed that the particle "مَا" is the negation conjunction, meaning "not"!

However, realizing that the particle "مَا" is the **relative pronoun** (إسم وصل), meaning "whatever", the indication of ﴿2:71﴾ becomes **A SIGNIFICANT WARNING**, and the confusion totally disappears!

فَذَبَحُوهَا وَمَا كَادُوا يَفْعَلُونَ ﴿2:71﴾

And they slaughtered her,
and whatever they schemed in the past, they (still) do.

It is like saying: "Whatever they bought, they eat." مَا اشْتَرَوا يَأْكُلُون

Or "Whatever they sowed, they reap!" مَا زَرَعُوا يَحْصُدُون

i.e., They (continue to) scheme (today) like they schemed in the past!

A SIGNIFICANT WARNING!

Here we made a distinction between the particle 'مَا' as they used it in tafseer books to mean "not", the negation conjunction; versus the way we use it to mean "whatever", which is the relative pronoun اسم وصل in Arabic. Just by making that change and that choice, the whole āyah 2:71 became very clear and profound. Revealing a significant warning to all of us regarding how certain people have played with the semantics of the Qurʿān, and purposefully changed how the semantics of the Qurʿān are communicated to us. So, I encourage you to go back to that segment if you have not seen it, because we're going to make extensive use of this concept.

Therefore this "Bay-yināt", which is the "Tafṣeel", is a deduction technique that we use in the interpretation of āyah 2:71. And just to summarize, the āyah ends with this sentence: *"And they slaughtered her, and whatever they schemed in the past, they (still) do."* This is a significant warning that Allahh (SWA) included in āyah 2:71. Here, we learned a significant piece of knowledge that Allahh (SWA) has deposited for us in those āyat from Sūrah Al Baqarah because we were able to employ "Tafṣeel" correctly.

We will take a couple more examples before we dive into āyah 3:7, because I really want to stress the concept of "Tafṣeel". I really want you to understand how significant this concept is. If you recall, last time we said "Tafṣeel" is a direct interjection from Allahh (SWA), directly into our ability to comprehend. When Allahh (SWA) wants to guide someone, he gives him the "Tafṣeel". He gives him or her the ability to do the right segmentation. All of these things are extremely significant for you to comprehend the Qur'an.

Example No 1: Sūrah Az-Zukhruf

We are going to start with what Allahh (SWA) tellsus in Sūrah Az-Zukhruf (43:81):

أَعُوْذُ بِاللهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطٰانِ الرَّجِيْمِ

قُلْ إِن كَانَ لِلرَّحْمَٰنِ وَلَدٌ فَأَنَا۠ أَوَّلُ ٱلْعَٰبِدِينَ ﴿43:81﴾ - الزخرف

M.M.Pickthall: Say (O Muhammad): If the Beneficent One hath a son, then, I shall be first among the worshippers. (But there is no son).
A.Y.Ali: Say: "If (God) Most Gracious had a son, I would be the first to worship."
A.J.Arberry: Say: 'If the All-merciful has a son, then I am the first to serve him.
M. Asad: Say [O Prophet]: "If the Most Gracious [truly] had a son, I would be the first to worship him!"
M.T.Qadri: Say: 'If (supposing the impossible) the Most Kind (Lord) had a son (or children), I would have been the first one to worship (him).'
M.A.S.Abdel Haleem: Say [Prophet], 'If the Lord of Mercy [truly] had offspring I would be the first to worship [them]
Saheeh International: Say, [O Muḥammad], "If the Most Merciful had a son, then I would be the first of [his] worshippers."
M. Khattab: Say, ⌜O Prophet,⌝ "If the Most Compassionate (really) had offspring, I would be the first worshipper."

This āyah has brought a lot of different opinions among the translators especially, but also among the interpreters. The books of Tafseer (interpreters) got it right in general, but for some reason, the translators insisted that they don't look at all of the different options given in the books of Tafseer. So, the translators took this a in a direction that was generally unacceptable, as we shall see.

M.M Pickthall translates this āyah as*: "Say (O Muhammad): If the Beneficent One hath a son, then, I shall be first among the worshippers."*. And then he adds in parentheses: *"(But there is no son)".* The āyah as he translated it, is just not acceptable. It implies that if Allahh or "Ar-Raḥmān" had a son, then the prophet (SAW) would be ordered to worship that son; and of course, that is not acceptable. This is not even conceivable to have that interpretation for this āyah.

Abdullah Yusuf Ali says: *"Say: 'If (God) Most Gracious had a son, I would be the first to worship.'"* Again, the same concept.

A.J Arberry Muhammad Asad, M.T Qadr, etc. All of them followed the same line of thinking, and their translations revolve around the same concept. All of these interpretations or translations are just unacceptable. It is not possible that Allahh (SWA) would include this type of meaning in this verse.

Now we fall back on "Tafṣeel", and we look at what else we can do to reconfigure the syntactic structure of the sentence, so that we can better understand it. Doing this, we end up with something very beautiful, if we realise that the Arabic word: إِنْ "Inn", at the beginning of a sentence, as it is in this āyah, is sometimes used as a negation particle, "NOT". That means the translation becomes:

Translation after proper Tafseel: Say: *"Ar-Raḥmān does not have a son! And thus, I am foremost among the wayfarers (the seekers, towards Allahh, along this creed)!"*

What creed is being referred to? The creed that "Ar-Raḥmān does not have a son!", as mentioned in the āyah. It becomes very beautiful, elegant, and very simple to understand. In fairness to the books of Tafseer, they included such opinions in some of them. Therefore, this is an issue mainly with the translators.

Example No 2: Sūrah Al-Haqqah

This example regarding "Tafṣeel" is a little bit more significant, so I hope you're paying attention, because all of these things apply to you as you engage the Qurʿān. In about a dozen āyat in the Qurʿān, we see this expression: وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا. For example, in Sūrah Al-Haqqah (69:3), Allahh (SWA) tells us:

وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا ٱلْحَآقَّةُ (69:3) - الحاقة

M. Khattab: And what will make you realize what the Inevitable Hour is?
Saheeh International: And what can make you know what is the Inevitable Reality?

I'm not going to get into ٱلْحَآقَّةُ "Al-Haqqah". I'm just going to focus on the highlighted expression.

As an example, Dr. Kattab interprets this expression: *"And what will make you realize …"* As if it's addressing Muhammad (SAW), and asking him: "what do you know?", or "how will you know about this?" So, it's a question that has a little bit of disrespect toward the prophet (SAW). We want to seek a better understanding of this āyah. We need to find out if this is really what's meant by this type of expression.

Other examples like this can be seen in the āyat below. You can take the time to investigate them on your own.

وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا سَقَرُ (74:27) - المدثر	وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا عِلِّيُّونَ (83:19) - المطففين
وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا يَوْمُ ٱلْفَصْلِ (77:14) - المرسلات	وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا ٱلطَّارِقُ (86:2) - الطارق
وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا يَوْمُ ٱلدِّينِ (82:17) - الانفطار	وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا ٱلْعَقَبَةُ (90:12) - البلد
ثُمَّ مَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا يَوْمُ ٱلدِّينِ (82:18) - الانفطار	وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا لَيْلَةُ ٱلْقَدْرِ (97:2) - القدر
وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا سِجِّينٌ (83:8) - المطففين	وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا ٱلْقَارِعَةُ - (101:3) - القارعة
وَمَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا هِيَهْ (101:10) - القارعة	

So, what's the problem here? The problem is that they are assigning an implication of ignorance to our beloved (SAW). This is very important because it implies that they were thinking in a certain way as they were translating. This is not just a problem for the translators, this time it is also a problem for all books of Tafseer, as they all follow the same line of thinking.

Another problem is, just as they did in 2:71, they took the particle 'مَا', and they froze when they came to interpreting that particle. They did not allow themselves to think of any possible interpretation for the particle 'مَا'. So, they all assumed that 'مَا' is an interrogation preposition meaning "what?", or "what would make you?" And they also assume that the letter 'و' (that precedes 'مَآ أَدْرَىٰكَ مَا') is a simple conjunction.

Now, if we switch our thinking a little bit, and seek guidance from Allahh (SWA), using the concept of "Tafṣeel", we end up with something significantly different. And we ended up with a beautiful interpretation that elevates the status of our beloved (SAW) within the Qur'an. Now pay attention. If we change 'مَا' into a relative pronoun, so it becomes "whatever". And if we also change the letter 'و' to the oath article, then the indication dramatically changes as if it's magic. And then the indication of such expression becomes: *"I swear by what made you realize…"* or *"I swear by what taught you."* It's a beautiful expression. It confirms that our beloved (SAW) was taught by Allahh (SWA). He was taught by a source of knowledge that Allahh himself is swearing by. It makes the expression so beautiful, so tender, and so dear to our heart. And then we understand it in a way that it's supposed to be understood.

This impacts about a dozen different āyat of the Qurʿān, as you see in the examples given above.

Aya 3:7: The Confusion Created to Justify the Pseudo-Science of "Muḥkam and Mutashābih"

المُحْكَم وَالْمُتَشَابِه

Now we move to the actual subject of this video, which is āyah 3:7. This is the famous āyah that talks about المُحْكَم وَالْمُتَشَابِه "Muḥkam and Mutashābih". For those of you who don't know, we have collections in our tradition called Ulum Al-Qurʿān "the sciences of Qurʿān." There are several experts throughout our history who have written significant encyclopedic type of works. "Muḥkam and Mutashābih" occupy a lot of space in those types of encyclopedic works. So, this is a significant thing. This is not a minor issue, and it impacts how we deal with the rest of the Qurʿān, as you will see very shortly.

I will start with the āyah itself. First of all, I will read it in Arabic, and then I will give you one of the typical interpretations and translations from Sahih International, so that we can know exactly how they thought about it. Eventually, we will use "Tafṣeel" to reorganize and reconfigure the syntactic structure of these sentences, and we will learn something dramatically different, and something profound that this āyah is teaching us.

Typical Interpretation and Translation (Sahih International)

هُوَ ٱلَّذِىٓ أَنزَلَ عَلَيْكَ ٱلْكِتَٰبَ مِنْهُ ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ هُنَّ أُمُّ ٱلْكِتَٰبِ وَأُخَرُ مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ فَأَمَّا ٱلَّذِينَ فِى قُلُوبِهِمْ زَيْغٌ فَيَتَّبِعُونَ مَا تَشَٰبَهَ مِنْهُ ٱبْتِغَآءَ ٱلْفِتْنَةِ وَٱبْتِغَآءَ تَأْوِيلِهِۦ ۗ وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُۥٓ إِلَّا ٱللَّهُ وَٱلرَّٰسِخُونَ فِى ٱلْعِلْمِ يَقُولُونَ ءَامَنَّا بِهِۦ ۙ كُلٌّ مِّنْ عِندِ رَبِّنَا وَمَا يَذَّكَّرُ إِلَّآ أُولُوا۟ ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ ﴿3:7﴾ - آل عمران

It is He who has sent down to you, [O Muḥammad], the Book; in it are verses [that are] precise - they are the foundation of the Book - and others unspecific. As for those in whose hearts is deviation [from truth], they will follow that of it which is unspecific, seeking discord and seeking an interpretation [suitable to them]. And no one knows its [true] interpretation except Allah. But those firm in knowledge say, "We believe in it. All [of it] is from our Lord." And no one will be reminded except those of understanding.

This is the original Arabic, and the Sahih International translation of this āyah. And again, Sahih International did not invent the interpretation. He just translated the existing interpretation that exists in all books of Tafseer. And as you will see, there are significant problems with their interpretations and therefore the translations.

The first problem we encounter is the translation of ٱلْكِتَٰبِ "Al-Kitab" as "the book". The correct meaning is "The layers of understanding on top of the scripture"

The second problem is that مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ is assigned the meaning "precise". We will see that this is not adequate.

Some other problems are that مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ is translated as "unspecific", and the word زَيْغٌ is given the meaning "deviation (from truth)". We will clarify these shortly insha Allahh.

Notice the complete stop (full stop) after the sentence “And no one knows its true interpretation except Allahh.” This is significant.

This translation (Sahih International), along with the problems we have pointed out, is aligned with the vast majority of books of Tafseer. We have not found major deviations from any of the books of Tafseer or from any other books of translation.

Now let's dive into this āyah in accordance with the Abrahamic locution, and using this “Bay-yināt” that we've demonstrated earlier, which is “Tafṣeel”, the syntactic segmentation. We look at different ways to understand the same sentences, but extract a lot more significant meanings and significant semantics.

Translation using “Tafṣeel”

1	He is the one who caused to be made accessible upon you the (message within the) scripture, from him (i.e., from Allahh):	هُوَ ٱلَّذِىٓ أَنزَلَ عَلَيْكَ ٱلْكِتَٰبَ مِنْهُ 1
2	(All of it consists of) Ayats that are semantically crafted with precision,	ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ 2
3	that are (of several types):	هُنَّ:
4	(Some of them are) The “mother of the scripture” (i.e., the contextual semantic bases, the authoritative sources of its meanings), and others that appear similar (to other portions of corrupted versions of earlier scriptures, or to other portions of the Qurʿān).	أُمُّ ٱلْكِتَٰبِ وَأُخَرُ مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ
5	As for people whose cores suffer diplopia (i.e., cannot focus on a single,	فَأَمَّا ٱلَّذِينَ فِى قُلُوبِهِمْ زَيْغٌ
6	they follow that which is similar (i.e., they adopt the understanding from similar appearing portions in corrupted versions of earlier scriptures) instead of it (i.e., instead of the Qurʿān),	فَيَتَّبِعُونَ مَا تَشَٰبَهَ مِنْهُ 3
7	seeking (to cause) tribulation,	ٱبْتِغَآءَ ٱلْفِتْنَةِ
8	and seeking (the reputation of knowing) its interpretation.	وَٱبْتِغَآءَ تَأْوِيلِهِ
9	But no one truly knows its interpretation except Allahh and those who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge (from Allahh).	وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُۥٓ إِلَّا ٱللَّهُ وَٱلرَّٰسِخُونَ فِى ٱلْعِلْمِ 4
10	(Those who are grounded firmly in evidence-based knowledge) They say: ‘We believe in it (i.e., the Qurʿān).	يَقُولُونَ ءَامَنَّا بِهِۦ
11	‘It (i.e., the Qurʿān) is intra-dependent in its totality, dependent upon the direction, as allowed (in accordance with our Weltanschauung) by our lord.’	كُلٌّ مِّنْ عِندِ رَبِّنَا 5
12	And none (may) seek to sow (new inquiries into his Weltanschauung) except those with guided cores.	وَمَا يَذَّكَّرُ إِلَّآ أُولُوا۟ ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ 6 آل عمران - ﴿3:7﴾

Right away, you will see that the translation is already starting to yield more information, meanings and semantics. The first variation here is that we included مِنْهُ at the end of the first sentence, instead of at the beginning of the next sentence. Why is this relevant? Here are the different translations:

Sahih International: *"It is He who has sent down to you, [O Muḥammad], the Book; in it are verses [that are] precise."* Notice that مِنْهُ "in it" is at the beginning of the sentence. He decided to terminate the sentence after ٱلْكِتَٰبِ "the book".

Using Tafseel: *"He is the one who caused to be made accessible upon you the (message within the) scripture, from him (i.e., from Allahh)."* In our translation, we decided to include مِنْهُ as part of the first sentence. So, there is a full stop after مِنْهُ, rather than before it.

Why did we do this? What authority do we have to allow ourselves this type of understanding? Let's look at the Qur'an itself to see if it uses مِنْهُ at the end of a sentence, as we have determined in here. To do this, we're going to see an example (labelled 1) from the Qur'an, a "Bay-yināt", evidence or proof that Allahh (SWA) uses مِنْهُ in the way that we are reading it.

Allahh (SWA) says in Sūrah Al-Jathiyah (45:13):

❶ وَسَخَّرَ لَكُم مَّا فِى ٱلسَّمَٰوَٰتِ وَمَا فِى ٱلْأَرْضِ جَمِيعًا مِّنْهُ. إِنَّ فِى ذَٰلِكَ لَءَايَٰتٍ لِّقَوْمٍ يَتَفَكَّرُونَ
﴿45:13﴾ - الجاثية

And he made subservient to you all that is in (the style of) the 'Samaawaat" (layers of understanding) and all that is in (the style of) the 'ardh' (the scripture), all together (indivisible) from him. Indeed, in that are signs for a community of people who reflect on their own.

Everybody agrees that there is a period right after مِنْهُ, as highlighted above.

Continuing with āyah 3:7, ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ is a new sentence, which is translated *as "(All of it consists of) āyat that are semantically crafted with precision"*. We're going to see that the word مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ is based on the root word "Hukum" or "Hakama" as gerund. We are going to dive into the nested interpretation shortly insha Allahh, and we're going to understand exactly what the word "Hukum" is. We're going to detail it, and then we're going to bring this translation into here, but we will leave it for now and dive into it a few minutes later. So, this sentence 'ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ' is a nominal sentence, joomla ismiyya, that describes ٱلْكِتَٰبِ.

In the third part of this āyah, the word هُنَّ is used by Allahh (SWA) to describe these ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ, these "semantically crafted with precision" type of āyat, and to divide them into many different categories. Therefore, هُنَّ is translated as *"that are (of several types):"* The āyah goes on to tell us the different types.

The first type is أُمُّ ٱلْكِتَٰبِ *"the mother of the scripture."* We're going to detail this a little bit more later in this segment insha Allahh. However, "the mother of the scripture" is translated or interpreted as *"the contextual semantic basis or the authoritative sources of its meanings."* What are those? Those are the āyat that gives us the solid foundation for extracting semantics. If you recall, according to our

methodology, Dhikr, the stories and the parables, contain a fixed context. And when we are looking at a fixed context, which is a story, we can extract a very specific meaning for every term and every expression. Therefore, these āyat or verses in the Dhikr, or the contextual sentences that really fix the semantics, give us the mother of the book, meaning the origination of any kind of formative definitions of semantics. Don't worry, I'm using a lot of big terms, just be patient. We're going to dive into a lot more details, stay with us, and you will see how beautiful and significant these concepts are.

We continue with the āyah, وَأُخَرُ مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ means *"and others that appear similar."* Remember, we looked at مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ in the prior segment. It means their appearance is similar. Now we have a brand-new concept here. This āyah is warning us; Allahh (SWA) has made accessible upon you Muhammad, a scripture where the āyat appear similar. Please take note that I said "appear similar". Why do I say appear? Because this letter 'ت' here مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ, implies intentionality. It implies that Allahh (SWA) purposefully made them appear similar. Right there, we have a major deviation from all of the books of Tafseer and all of the books of translations of the Qurʿān. مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ are definitely done, and put there for a purpose by Allahh (SWA), and we're going to see the purpose.

Here, we see a new piece of knowledge and we are forced to ask: Similar to what? Similar to other portions of corrupted versions of earlier scriptures or to other portions of the Qur'an. Meaning there are āyat that may look alike within the Qurʿān, but there are a set that may look alike to other corrupted versions of the scriptures. Why do I say this? You're going to see it for yourself. Just stay with us insha Allahh, and be patient, because I promise you this is time well spent. It's worth your investment in learning how to engage the Qurʿān. This specifically is teaching us to be careful. "I made them look like the other ones." (Paraphrasing).

We continue: فَأَمَّا ٱلَّذِينَ فِى قُلُوبِهِمْ زَيْغٌ *"As for people whose cores suffer diplopia."* زَيْغٌ means diplopia. What is diplopia? It is a defect in their eyes and in their field of vision, causing their eyes not to focus properly. So, their eyes are misaligned in terms of their ability to focus on a single object. That's called diplopia. When you look at someone who suffers from diplopia, you see that both eyes are not focused on one object. They cannot focus correctly because their muscles don't work correctly to focus on one single object. These people unfortunately see double, seeing two or more things at the same time. They cannot focus, and over time they need to train themselves to dismiss one field of their vision, and focus on the other. There are some corrective operations, and there are some corrective instruments that they may use.

This is the concept of diplopia. In Arabic it's called "ahwal", someone who is not able to focus on one specific object. In this āyah, this is the same word (زَيْغٌ) used with regard to the core, the "kalb or kulub". Meaning they cannot focus on a single thing or a single item.

The āyah continues: فَيَتَّبِعُونَ مَا تَشَٰبَهَ مِنْهُ, *"They follow that which is similar, instead of it."* Instead of what? Instead of 'Al-kitab' that was mentioned earlier in the āyah. Now we understand that مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ is talking about 'Al-kitab', this book, this Qurʿān, this scripture versus other things. So, diplopia involves having one eye on Al-Qurʿān, and another eye looking at something else outside the Qurʿān. And thus, you have this diplopia. Where? In your heart, not in Al-Qurʿān. The Qurʿān is telling us specifically that Allahh (SWA) included a category that appears similar, and now we understand what they are similar to.

So they have زَيْغٌ, the diplopia in their hearts, and they follow something else instead of the Qurʿān. So now it becomes very obvious what Allahh (SWA) is talking about. He's talking about those who see a story that, on the surface or at its superficial layer, looks like it is referring to a similar story from the book of Genesis of the corrupted version of the Torah; Or from a story that was brought over from the sixth or fifth century, or some stories people may have learned about from God knows where. The Qurʿān may include, at the surface, something that seems similar. So, when we talked about Dhul Qarnain; yes, there are other stories that seem similar to this story, but the Qurʿān is not talking about those stories.

The Qurʿān is giving us a layer at the surface that seems similar. This is مُتَشَٰبِهَٰتٌ. Allahh (SWA) is clearly telling us: (Paraphrasing) "Watch out. There are some āyat that are أُمُّ ٱلْكِتَٰبِ, and there are some āyat that appear similar to the outside sources you may look at." Now, people in whose hearts there is diplopia cannot remain focused on the Qurʿān itself. They will start following مَا تَشَٰبَهَ مِنْهُ, instead of it.

Now, I know some Arabic speaking brothers and sisters are going to jump at me in the comments stream. And they're going to say "مِنْهُ does not mean that." Well, مِنْهُ does mean that. Let me take you to point number three, to illustrate that we are following exactly what Allahh (SWA) is teaching us.

Let's go to Sūrah Quraysh (106:4)

❸ ٱلَّذِىٓ أَطْعَمَهُم مِّن جُوعٍ وَءَامَنَهُم مِّنْ خَوْفٍ ﴿106:4﴾ - قريش

Who has fed them instead of hunger and gave them security instead of fear.

Here, the preposition مِّنْ is clearly indicating "instead of". Between parentheses, this is really interesting because the Sūrah is talking about Quraysh, and it's teaching them to pay attention to these prepositions, which are not traditional in their interpretation, which is not the most obvious way of understanding these prepositions. Allahh (SWA) is teaching Quraysh specifically: (Paraphrasing) "Pay attention to how I use the prepositions, and pay attention to my locution and divine lexicon, don't impose yours." So, when Allahh (SWA) showed us how مِّنْ is used in Sūrah Quraysh, we do the nested interpretation for it, we bring it here and we implement it. We use it for this مِنْهُ here: فَيَتَّبِعُونَ مَا تَشَٰبَهَ مِنْهُ. Therefore, we arrive at the interpretation of "instead of it".

Now it becomes very clear, so don't go following the other thing that you think this could look similar to. Allahh (SWA) is pointing out a very big problem that all of the Muslim scholars fell into, as we consistently and repeatedly demonstrate on this channel. They had this diplopia in their heart, and therefore, they went outside the Qurʿān to learn from those other sources, and they brought them over to the Qurʿān. The Qurʿān is very clear in this āyah. It's talking about it so convincingly as I've showed you so far.

The part that comes next is the worst and most damaging part. Allahh (SWA) continues by telling us why they do this: ٱبْتِغَآءَ ٱلْفِتْنَةِ *"Seeking to cause tribulation"* or وَٱبْتِغَآءَ تَأْوِيلِهِ *"seeking its interpretation."* What does that mean? They may have good intentions for seeking the right interpretation, however, they made a mistake by going to the other sources. Or Allahh (SWA) is telling us they are *"seeking the*

reputation of knowing its interpretation" or seeking the reputation of being knowledgeable about the Qurʿān, and being the source of knowledge, or the spokesperson for Allahh about the Qurʿān. This is more illicit, and not necessarily a pure intention. These two clauses: ٱبْتِغَآءَ ٱلْفِتْنَةِ and وَٱبْتِغَآءَ تَأْوِيلِهِ tell us specifically that there are people who did this on purpose.

Therefore, when you write me in the comments, and you get on my case, asking: "Why do you always talk about some of those earliest scholars, and some of those people who did their best with the limited knowledge they had?" It is because, right here, Allahh (SWA) is telling us that their intention was not necessarily pure. Some of those people had the wrong intention to cause tribulations, fitna and divisions in the ummah. While some others did it, not necessarily to cause tribulations, but to seek the reputation of knowing its interpretation. Therefore, we are not exaggerating when we say that not everything that we received was written with pure intentions. The mistakes they made were not always made in an innocent fashion. Some of them were done purposefully to get to a certain result that Allahh (SWA) disclosed right here in this āyah. Now you understand perhaps why they work so hard to misrepresent this āyah. Allahu alam. But we need to make sure that we keep our minds open, and read the Qurʿān with virgin eyes. Allahh (SWA) is telling us they were seeking tribulation, and they were seeking interpretation maybe without sufficient knowledge, or they're seeking the reputation of knowing its interpretation.

And now we continue with the same āyah. Remember in the Sahih International translation where we took note of the full sop after the sentence: وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُ إِلَّا ٱللَّهُ *"And no one knows its true interpretation except Allahh."* He put a stop after "Allah". This is legitimate Arabic, by the way, what he did was not wrong. However, there are many other āyat that Allahh (SWA) gives us in the Qurʿān, which teach us that وَٱلرَّٰسِخُونَ فِى ٱلْعِلْمِ *"those who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge from Allahh,"* know or may learn how to do its interpretation.

And of course, on this channel, we teach that we have a methodology. We have the self-correcting methodology, which helps us move closer to Allahh (SWA), and the interpretation comes from Allahh. Therefore, if you are among those who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge (ٱلْعِلْمِ), very methodological, very persistent, very disciplined, and you don't allow subjective interjections into the conceptions of the meanings of the āyat. Allahh (SWA) will give you the understanding.

And therefore, this āyah allows us to say: وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُ إِلَّا ٱللَّهُ وَٱلرَّٰسِخُونَ فِى ٱلْعِلْمِ *"But no one truly knows its interpretation except Allahh and those who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge (from Allahh)."* We have two subjects for the verb يَعْلَمُ . The first is Allahh, and the second is those who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge. In other words, these are the people to whom Allahh (SWA) supplies the knowledge.

Now we start a new sentence: يَقُولُونَ ءَامَنَّا بِهِ *"Those who are grounded firmly in evidence-based knowledge) They say: 'We believe in it (i.e., the Qurʿān)."* Who is يَقُولُونَ referring to? This is a new verb. And if we say this is a new sentence, of course, this would be an incomplete sentence, and this is wrong. But in the Qurʿān, there is a style called al-ihtibak, which is having two different sentences that overlap each other by one, two or three words. This means the two sentences share one common part of each other. In this case:

The first sentence is: وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُ إِلَّا ٱللَّهُ وَٱلرَّٰسِخُونَ فِى ٱلْعِلْمِ That's the first complete sentence.

And the second sentence is: وَٱلرَّٰسِخُونَ فِى ٱلْعِلْمِ يَقُولُونَ ءَامَنَّا بِهِۦ

Notice that the two sentences share a common part, which is highlighted below in brackets:

وَمَا يَعْلَمُ تَأْوِيلَهُ إِلَّا ٱللَّهُ **(وَٱلرَّٰسِخُونَ فِى ٱلْعِلْمِ)** يَقُولُونَ ءَامَنَّا بِهِۦ

But no one truly knows its interpretation except Allahh **(and those who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge (from Allahh)).** They say: 'We believe in it (i.e., the Qurʿān).

Now this is perfect. This is perfect Arabic, by the way, not just perfect Qurʿān. This is a well-known instrument in eloquence of Arabic in bayan and badea. Those of you who don't believe me, look up a book by Imam Al Bika'i. He has written a book called **Al-Ihtibak fil Qurʿān**, with over 350 different examples from the Qurʿān where it uses such overlapping of two sentences to end up with something more eloquent. The Qurʿān has many of such examples.

We will now look at an āyah from Sūrah Al Baqarah (2:120) that confirms this interpretation

4 ... قُلْ إِنَّ هُدَى ٱللَّهِ هُوَ ٱلْهُدَىٰ وَلَئِنِ ٱتَّبَعْتَ أَهْوَآءَهُم بَعْدَ ٱلَّذِى جَآءَكَ مِنَ ٱلْعِلْمِ مَا لَكَ مِنَ ٱللَّهِ مِن وَلِىٍّ وَلَا نَصِيرٍ ﴿2:120﴾ - البقرة

...Say: 'Indeed the guidance from Allahh is the true guidance!' And if you follow their opinions after what you have been given, directly, of the evidence-based knowledge, then you shall have, instead of Allahh, neither a protector nor a supporter. ﴿2:120﴾

Therefore, this āyah proves that Allahh (SWA) gives this knowledge to certain people. So, we have people who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge as this āyah clearly demonstrates. Now we understand that this āyah 3:7 is possibly talking about this type of overlapping that was just described.

Between parentheses, this āyah is another demonstration that مِنَ ٱللَّهِ means "instead of Allahh". So, the preposition مِنَ in here clearly means "instead of". And again, another demonstration that مِنْهُ as we saw it in āyah 3:7 means "instead of it" or "instead of the Qurʿān". I hope you're following. I know this is a lot of details, and a lot of information, but it's really essential and we're building something significant.

This is going to give you so much power and so much confidence that we're doing the right thing on this channel. We're following the right methodology, and we have the right concepts built upon the Qur'an. As you will see shortly, this āyah is a methodological āyah which is full of information that guides us as to how to look at the Qurʿān, and how to understand why there are similarities between the Quranic stories and other stories that could be found in the corrupted versions of earlier scriptures.

So, we continue: كُلٌّ مِّنْ عِندِ رَبِّنَا *"It (i.e., the Qurʿān) is intra-dependent in its totality, dependent upon the direction, as allowed (in accordance with our Weltanschauung) by our lord."*

This is a very short sentence right here. And as you see, when we translate it in order to give it justice, we have to really expand as much as we can to keep the semantics as concise, clear and faithful to the original. Allahh (SWA) is telling us that these people who are grounded firmly in evidence-based knowledge, they believe in the Qurʿān and they say: كُلٌّ.

This word كُلٌّ is the plural of كَلٌّ. Let's look at this example in Sūrah An Nahl (16:76):

5 وَضَرَبَ ٱللَّهُ مَثَلًا رَّجُلَيْنِ أَحَدُهُمَآ أَبْكَمُ لَا يَقْدِرُ عَلَىٰ شَىْءٍ وَهُوَ كَلٌّ* عَلَىٰ مَوْلَىٰهُ أَيْنَمَا يُوَجِّههُ
لَا يَأْتِ بِخَيْرٍ هَلْ يَسْتَوِى هُوَ وَمَن يَأْمُرُ بِٱلْعَدْلِ وَهُوَ عَلَىٰ صِرَٰطٍ مُّسْتَقِيمٍ ﴿16:76﴾ - النحل

In an example, Allahh has separated between the examples of two men, one of them mute; he cannot do anything (independently), and he is fully dependent upon his master wherever he (his master) points him; he provides no beneficial use (otherwise). Can he be at the same level as someone who commands justice, and who he is upon the self correcting methodology? ﴿16:76﴾

Allahh (SWA) is giving us the example of two men. One of them is mute, he cannot do anything, and he's fully dependent upon his master. Allahh (SWA) describes him using the word: كَلٌّ. This is very clear what this āyah is saying. كَلٌّ means fully dependent. So, when Allahh (SWA) uses the same word, كُلٌّ, which is the plural of كَلٌّ, it means collectively. All of it interdependent in its totality, and dependent upon the guidance as allowed by our Lord. Why do we say dependent upon the guidance as allowed by our Lord? If you recall, when we talked about the splitting of samaawaat from al ardh. Allahh (SWA) made it clear to us in that āyah, which we discussed in part four of the series on Sūrah Abasa. Allahh (SWA) made it very clear that the understanding comes from him. The guidance to help you see the āyat, the signs comes from Allahh. Therefore, it's not in the scripture. And those who are firmly grounded in evidence-based knowledge, they know this, they understand that the whole thing is collectively intra-dependent, and it's understanding has to come at the direction from Allahh (SWA). And if you recall, we added one more thing in that part of Sūrah Abasa, which is the understanding that comes to you is commensurate or apportioned in relationship to your own state, to your understanding, to your arsch, or to your own Weltanschauung.

Therefore, there are so many concepts right here in these four words: كُلٌّ مِّنْ عِندِ رَبِّنَا. And that's why we have to expand the translation to include all of these details.

We continue with the last part: وَمَا يَذَّكَّرُ إِلَّآ أُولُوا ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ *"And none (may) seek to sow (new inquiries into his Weltanschauung) except those with guided cores."* If you remember the series from Sūrah 'Abasa, we talked about يَذَّكَّرُ. We described it as sewing the questions in your Weltanschauung. It's asking these daring questions that signify and admit with humility that you need help understanding. And when you sow these questions in your Weltanschauung, Allahh (SWA) will eventually allow you to spontaneously receive some understanding later on, after you do يَذَّكَّرُ 'yazzakar'. So يَذَّكَّرُ does not mean to remember. It means to so new inquiries into the Weltanschauung, and Allahh (SWA) may give you the answers later, according to his will. And these answers appear spontaneously.

We have covered a significant part of this āyah, and now we're going to see the last nested interpretation that refers to أُولُوا ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ in this āyah, from Sūrah Az-Zumar (39:18). Allahh (SWA) tells us:

❻ ٱلَّذِينَ يَسْتَمِعُونَ ٱلْقَوْلَ فَيَتَّبِعُونَ أَحْسَنَهُۥٓ أُو۟لَٰٓئِكَ ٱلَّذِينَ هَدَىٰهُمُ ٱللَّهُ وَأُو۟لَٰٓئِكَ هُمْ أُو۟لُوا ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ
الزُّمَر - ﴿39:18﴾

Those who listen to the discourse (of the Qurʿān) and then follow the truth embedded (i.e., concealed) within. Those are the ones who are guided by Allahh, and those are the ones with guided cores. ﴿39:18﴾

Remember the word أَحْسَنَهُ does not mean better. Because here, if you say: "they follow the better of it" or "the best of it." It may imply that only part of the Qurʿān is good, or that some parts are better than others. But all the Qurʿān is good. You cannot say this part is better than that. Therefore, أَحْسَنَهُ does not mean better. It means the truth that's concealed within the text and the words of the Qurʿān, not the superficial layers. The rest of the āyah says: *"Those are the ones who are guided by Allahh, and those are the ones with guided cores."* This gives us a very clear definition of أُولُوا ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ as "the guided cores." So how did we reach this? Because Allahh (SWA) is teaching us; first, you seek the truth inside, and then Allahh guides you, and you become among those with the guided cores. This is clearly an āyah that defines أُولُوا ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ.

As a result of this nested interpretation, we are able to interpret the last part of āyah 3:7 the way we did. Therefore, the interpretation becomes: *"none may seek to sow new inquiries into his or her Weltanschauung, except those with guided cores."* In other words, Allahh should have guided you first to this methodology that we're talking about, the 'sirata 'l mustakim'. If you don't even understand the 'sirata 'l mustakim', if you have not studied the methodology, as we were teaching on this channel, you don't even recognize that you need to sow new questions, and you don't even recognize that you ask these questions, and you wait patiently and humbly for Allahh (SWA) to fill your cup. You don't approach the Qurʿān with a full cup; you approach the Qurʿān with an empty cup. To have an empty cup means that you ask questions to which you don't know the answers. You don't presume you know the answers. That characteristic, by itself, applies to those with the guided cores. So, this is what this last part of āyah 3:7 says.

You may have noticed we have skipped over a couple of points. The first one we will return to is point number 2 regarding ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ. So, let's dive into it a little bit. In Sūrah Hud (11:1), Allahh (SWA) tells us:

❷ الٓر كِتَٰبٌ أُحْكِمَتْ ءَايَٰتُهُۥ ثُمَّ فُصِّلَتْ مِن لَّدُنْ حَكِيمٍ خَبِيرٍ ﴿11:1﴾ - هود

Alif-Lām-Ra. A scripture whose ayats are (all) semantically precise, and whose syntactic segmentation is then provided (in real time) from one who is simultaneously a source of linguistic discernment, and with intimate expertise. ﴿11:1﴾

أُحْكِمَتْ is the verb that's used, which applies to all of the āyat, ALL of them. In some of the books of Tafseer, they decided to say that only part of the āyat are أُحْكِمَتْ. However, the sentence in this āyah is very clear. The whole Kitab is full of āyat, and all of them are أُحْكِمَتْ, not just part of them. So, all of the scriptures āyat are semantically precise.

As we discussed in part 2.2 of this series, the syntactic segmentation is then provided in real time from Allahh (SWA), described in this āyah as *"one who is simultaneously a source of linguistic discernment and with an intimate expertise."* Intimate expertise about what? About our own Weltanschauung. Allahh (SWA) has the most intimate knowledge about our Weltanschauung, in real time. Therefore, when we are working on engaging the Qurʿān, doing tadabbur, Allahh (SWA) guides us with the Tafseel. And just as Allahh (SWA) guides us with the Tafseel of all the āyat, Allahh (SWA) is confirming that all of the āyat are أُحْكِمَتْ, they all have the semantically precise composition.

Therefore, when we started āyah 3:7 by saying, all of the āyat are ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ, not some of them. Now we justify fully from the Qurʿān that مِنْهُ (in row 2 of the table) does not belong as the beginning of this sentence. This is because ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ is not just one category of the āyat of the Qurʿān. No, the Kitab is all from Allahh (SWA), real time. All of it come as ءَايَٰتٌ مُّحْكَمَٰتٌ, semantically precise āyat from Allahh (SWA). And remember, āyat is not just the text, it is the understanding that comes directly from Allahh (SWA), from the "Samaawaat", which are the layers of understanding.

And therefore, this āyah 3:7 is clearly telling us that the understanding comes from Allahh (SWA), all of the signs come precise and semantically correct, and they are divided into several categories. Some of them are "Ummul Kitab", and others are similar in appearance.

أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ The mother of the Message of Scripture

So now we go forward to the next part of this segment, and we're going to dive into one concept that we have not discussed in detail yet, which is أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ "The mother of the message of the scripture." Remember Al Kitab is the message that comes from the Samaawaat. And this is the part that Allahh (SWA) provides us, in the form of understanding, in response to the questions that we sowed in our Weltanschauung when we do يَذَّكَّرُ (Dhikr). This is an example that I want to share with you to cement the concept, and to help you understand what أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ is. We are going to dive into it even more, but now we're just going to introduce the concept.

Sour dough Mother (Poolish)

Those of you who know anything about baking, or those of you who have this hobby of learning about baking or making bread, you know about something called sourdough. Sourdough is this chewy and sour type of tasting bread that's really delicious with certain types of dishes, especially in the winter. It's hardy, and kind of filling as you eat it. For this type of bread, you have to prepare something called the mother. The mother basically is the yeast that has fermented over a number of days before you use it for baking. And the yeast that is grown, as you see in this jar pictured above, is referred to as the mother, the sourdough mother or the polish. So, what you do is you take a part of the mother, and you use it in your baking for that day. Then you add a couple of tablespoons of flour to the mother, and a little bit more water perhaps, and you cover it again loosely, and you allow it to grow again.

This is the mother, it's the source. It's sort of the template, the cookie cutter, the basis, or the foundry of all of the yeast that you use to create all of these bubbles in the sourdough bread.

Vinegar Mother

Another example is vinegar. As you know, the vinegar grows based on the acetobacter bacteria. The acetobacter bacteria eats the sugars in the juice of whatever you're trying to convert into vinegar, and it forms this gelatinous layer that sinks to the bottom of the jar or the bottle, or wherever you're preparing the vinegar in. Over time, you can take part of this, you may throw it away, or you add some fruit. That layer of a gelatinous nature that has all of the bacteria in it, and grows over time is called the mother. And you can take out some of the vinegar, put new types of juice, and you create more vinegar, etc. So, you have like a factory, a foundry, or a template, based on which you keep repeating the process again and again. This is exactly what Allahh (SWA) is talking about when he said: “they are the mother of the book.”

So which āyat is he talking about? He's talking about āyat that give you the precise definitions. You go back to those specific āyat to understand the semantics, the definitions, the meanings, and the indications of the specific terms of the Abrahamic locution, and you do the nested interpretation. Then you take those meanings and you apply them in other āyat. This is the process that we've described so many times before in every segment. Allahh (SWA) in āyah 3:7, refers to these mother āyat as أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ “the mother of Al-Kitab”. This is exactly the concept.

ٱلْحُكْم “Al-Ḥukm”

We're going to see an illustration with the word ٱلْحُكْم . In many prior segments I've already explained that ٱلْحُكْم refers specifically to the linguistic discernment, and now we're going to detail it. I've done it before in other segments, but I'm going to repeat it because this is a really perfect example for what we're talking about regarding the mother of the message of the scripture, أُمُّ الْكِتَابِ. So, let's look at āyah number 40 from Sūrah Yusuf (12:40)

Allahh (SWA) is referring to a conversation taking place in prison, between Yusuf and two of his prison mates. He's inviting them to Islam, and he's inviting them to understand correctly, to clear their Weltanschauung before they connect with Allahh (SWA). Watch how beautiful this āyah is, and how much of a description and definition of the word ٱلْحُكْم it is.

This is Yusuf speaking. He says:

مَا تَعْبُدُونَ مِن دُونِهِ إِلَّآ أَسْمَآءً سَمَّيْتُمُوهَآ أَنتُمْ وَءَابَآؤُكُم مَّآ أَنزَلَ ٱللَّهُ بِهَا مِن سُلْطَٰنٍ

إِنِ ٱلْحُكْمُ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ

أَمَرَ أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوٓاْ إِلَّآ إِيَّاهُ ذَٰلِكَ ٱلدِّينُ ٱلْقَيِّمُ وَلَٰكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ ٱلنَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ ﴿12:40﴾ - يوسف

Those in accordance with which you seek guidance, placing them between you and him (Allahh), are but labels (i.e., names, terms, expressions, concepts) you all have designated, you and your forefathers: Allahh never made accessible using them (i.e., the labels) any authoritativeness. The linguistic discernment belongs but to Allahh.

He commanded that you seek guidance in accordance with none but him: That is truly the persistently established "deen", but, alas, most people do not aspire to evidence-based knowledge. ﴿12:40﴾

Remember, مِن دُونِهِ. means to place intermediaries between oneself and Allahh, such as an Imam, a Wali, a translator or interpreter, a sheikh, a scholar, or even a messenger or a prophet, or whatever you take guidance from between you and Allahh. Yusuf (AS) is teaching people not to do this. He says about the intermediaries: They *"are but labels…"* What does that mean? Their names, their terms, their expressions, their concepts, *"you all have designated"*. In other words, you invented this concept. You invented this idea, this name, and you assigned it some sort of designation. You defined the term, the name, or the label. Allahh (SWA) is very clearly using the word أَسْمَآءً, which are labels, names, nouns, verbs, or expressions.

So, Yusuf is saying (paraphrasing): "pay attention to the labels with which you start, you are worshiping in accordance with these things, and you seek guidance along your understanding of these labels you have designated your forefathers and yourselves, and you invented them." The Arabic dictionaries come from Arab poets. Some of them may be correct, and some of them may be wrong. We have to refer to the divine lexicon in the Qurʿān to see if Allahh (SWA) approves of, or used some of these indications. If you look at a typical dictionary definition for a typical word, you may find 10, 15 or even 20 different possible meanings. How do you decide? How do you determine which one you choose? You can use your own opinion, or you can refer to the Qurʿān and see how Allahh (SWA) used that term in the Qurʿān, and what he used the term to mean or indicate. And there's a whole process, as we described before.

The ayah continues about the labels: *"Allahh never made accessible using them (i.e., the labels) any authoritativeness"* What is that saying? Yusuf (AS) is telling them (Paraphrasing): "Look, these labels that

you selected are not necessarily the labels that Allahh uses. Allahh (SWA) chooses the labels he uses. So, don't make up your own labels and claim that Allahh is speaking your language." That is a form of shirk. That is perhaps the worst form of belying the Qurʿān, because Allahh is using his selected language, and his divine lexicon. And you're saying: "No, no, no. I'm going to interpret it according to my own language, my own lexicon, my own locution." That is a form of shirk. Allahh (SWA) is teaching us, by the statement of Yusuf, that if you have designated that meaning, it doesn't mean that Allahh is going to give it authoritativeness. Allahh never made accessible using such labels, anything that is authoritative. So, don't make that claim. It is shirk.

And then the next part is so beautiful: إِنِ ٱلۡحُكۡمُ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ *"Linguistic discernment belongs but to Allahh."* Only Allahh has the right to determine the linguistic discernment of the terms, the vocabulary, and the lexicon used in the Qurʿān. By understanding this, we eliminate so many disagreements. We have a clear reference field, and a divine lexicon we can all go back to. We may disagree on maybe some nuances, but the fixed context of dhikr, and the stories, gives us a solid foundation to stand on. And thus, we become grounded firmly in the evidence of the Qurʿān. We don't have to make it up. We don't have to have religious arguments. We can go back to the evidence, according to the Qurʿān, and then we make a decision. There may still be some nuances, and some different possibilities, but it's all based on the Qurʿān itself. Not based on opinions of this poet, or 'Ibn Fulan said this,' or 'Abu so and so said this.' We don't care about those things anymore. We return to the evidence from the Qurʿān.

We continue the āyah just to make sure it's completed. In this conclusion of the āyah Yusuf says: *"He commanded that you seek guidance in accordance with none but him: That is truly the persistently established "deen", but, alas, most people do not aspire to evidence-based knowledge."* In other words, Yusuf is saying this is not new, Allahh (SWA) is always the one who owns the vocabulary which you use أَسۡمَآءٌ, but unfortunately, most people do not aspire to evidence based knowledge. They want to choose the lazy, lethargic way.

Gift #1: الأَسْماءُ الْحُسْنى Al-Asmaa'ul Hussna

In āyah 180 of Sūrah Al A'raf (7:180), Allahh (SWA) tells us:

وَلِلَّهِ ٱلۡأَسۡمَآءُ ٱلۡحُسۡنَىٰ فَٱدۡعُوهُ بِهَا وَذَرُوا ٱلَّذِينَ يُلۡحِدُونَ فِيٓ أَسۡمَٰٓئِهِ
سَيُجۡزَوۡنَ مَا كَانُوا يَعۡمَلُونَ ﴿7:180﴾ - الأعراف

To Allahh belongs the insightful labels (i.e., names, terms, expressions, concepts), and thus, use them to supplicate to him; And abandon those who bury sideways (i.e., hide and/or misappropriate) his labels: They shall be recompensed in accordance with the vocabulary over which they toiled. ﴾7:180﴿

Remember, the word: يَعۡمَلُونَ in the Qurʿān, according to the Abrahamic locution, always refers to "the vocabulary that they toil on," or "they work through the āyat to extract the vocabulary." So, they will be recompensed according to whatever vocabulary they use based on their thinking and their opinions.

Now, we were told ٱلْأَسْمَآءُ ٱلْحُسْنَىٰ referred to “the beautiful attributes” or “beautiful names” of Allahh (SWA), as if Allahh has proper names. Allahh does not have proper names. He does not need the proper names. These are descriptions, but they're not the only ones that this āyah refers to. As we saw a little earlier when we discussed āyah number 40 from Sūrah Yusuf, أَسْمَآءٌ is generic, and it is referring to all the vocabulary in the Qurʿān. ٱلْحُكْم, which is linguistic discernment, belongs to Allahh regarding every single name, and every single expression used within the Qurʿān.

In other words, as we said, if you use a name, a label, a noun or an expression, and you assign it your own meaning away from how Allahh (SWA) used that label within the Qurʿān, within the scripture, you are actually committing shirk. You are actually attributing your own authority over the authority of Allahh (SWA). Even worse, you could be misleading a lot of people, and you earn the bad deeds for that misleading of those people.

So, ٱلْأَسْمَآءُ ٱلْحُسْنَىٰ is clearly referring to the names, labels, nouns or attributes Allahh (SWA) has endowed with truth ‘ٱلْحُسْنَىٰ’. If you remember, we talked about this many times before. أَحْسَنَهُ, ‘Hassan’ and ٱلْحُسْنَىٰ refer to the truth within, the truth within the names, or the truth within the stories. So, when Allahh (SWA) says in Sūrah Yusuf: نَحْنُ نَقُصُّ عَلَيْكَ أَحْسَنَ الْقَصَصِ, it is typically translated as*: “we recite upon you using stories that are the best in stories.”* However, it's not simply referring to the best, or the most beautiful stories. It's referring to the truth within these stories, or the truth below the superficial layer of these stories. Allahh (SWA) is teaching us in this āyah, that أَسْمَآءٌ in the Qurʿān, all the labels, and all the vocabulary are ٱلْحُسْنَىٰ, selected by Allahh to contain and carry the truth. We should supplicate to Allahh using these names and these labels. We should refer to these labels, the vocabulary, and the divine lexicon in our supplication. This is a direct command from Allahh (SWA).

To confirm this understanding, Allahh (SWA) says: وَذَرُوا ٱلَّذِينَ يُلْحِدُونَ. What is يُلْحِدُونَ ? It comes from an Arabic word ‘Lakhada’ or ‘Lakhad’. So ‘Lakhad’ refers to the L-shaped bottom of a tomb that people dig through the earth sideways to create a pocket under the side of that tomb, and they deposit the body within it on the side. So, it's an L-shaped bottom, if you can imagine it. Allahh (SWA) is referring to people who misuse the vocabulary as if they're burying deep and sideways, the meanings and the understanding of the real vocabulary. Allahh (SWA) is telling us to abandon those people, move away from them, don't listen to them, don't refer to what they teach you, and don't accept what they claim, or their opinions. Allahh (SWA) selected his own labels, and endowed them with the truth ‘ٱلْحُسْنَىٰ’. Use those to make the DuƐāʿ, فَٱدْعُوهُ بِهَا.

This should be a huge wake up for the whole Muslim community. Every single Muslim in the world should be interested in this fact. Ask yourself right now: Do you know anybody around you who is actually exclusively using the labels, the nouns, and the divine lexicon from the Qurʿān to make DuƐāʿ? Do you know any single person who has taught you this? Allahh (SWA) is clearly saying that we should use the names and the labels that he endowed with truth, to make supplication to him. And abandon those who confuse his names, who use his names in the wrong way, because they shall be recompensed in accordance with the vocabulary over which they toiled. The wrong vocabulary, the wrong meanings, and they shall receive the wrong recompense, which is not the recompense that they thought. It is a

recompense that is, possibly, against what they thought. This is confirmed in so many different āyat. Insha Allahh, we will discuss it in future episodes when we talk more about the secrets of supplication. In this channel, there are already three different episodes about the supplication, and the secrets of supplication.

Gift #2: What is ٱلْحِكْمَةَ "Al-Ḥikmah"?

Allahh (SWA) uses ٱلْحُكْمُ "Al-Ḥukm" to mean "the linguistic discernment", or assigning an exact meaning of each word in the Abrahamic Locution, as we just saw a little earlier in āyah 40 from Sūrah Yusuf. The question is: What is "Al-Hikmah"? By looking at the Islamic tradition, we find that philosophers such as Al-Fārābī and Ibn-Sīnā said that ٱلْحِكْمَةَ"Al-Ḥikmah" refers to "philosophy". Most of the translators of the Qurʿān refer to it as "wisdom". Imam Ash-Shāfi3ī, in his zeal to support the Hadith, and what's called the Sunnah, the written, reported tradition about our beloved (SAW), insisted that the word "Hikmah" refers to "the Sunnah". Allahh (SWA) would not approve of this because the word "Hikmah", as we shall see, is clearly defined in the Qurʿān. We don't need to make it up or invent it. We don't need to have our own opinion about it. Other scholars, such as, Az-Zamakhshari said it was the Injīl and the laws. Ar-Rāzī claimed it is معرفة ذات الله وصفاته وأفعاله: Knowledge about Allahh, his essence, his attributes, and his actions, etc. Others said that ٱلْحِكْمَةَ "Al-Ḥikmah" refers to the prophethood.

However, we refer to "Al Hikmah" in accordance to what the Qurʿān says. We look at this āyah, which is very clear, very obvious, very straightforward, and you will see it immediately as soon as you read it from Sūrah Az-Zukhruf (43:63). Allahh (SWA) describes an event with Ɛīssā (AS).

وَلَمَّا جَآءَ عِيسَىٰ بِٱلْبَيِّنَٰتِ قَالَ قَدْ جِئْتُكُم بِٱلْحِكْمَةِ وَلِأُبَيِّنَ لَكُم بَعْضَ ٱلَّذِى تَخْتَلِفُونَ فِيهِ فَٱتَّقُوا ٱللَّهَ وَأَطِيعُونِ ﴿43:63﴾ - الزخرف

And when 3īssā came with the instruments of deduction (i.e., the techniques for extracting evidence from the scripture) he said: "I brought you Al-Ḥikmah, and to expose to you, in accordance with your ways, some of what you used to disagree about among yourselves. And thus, be disciplined in your seeking of Allahh, and obey me!" ﴿43:63﴾

Remember, Ɛīssā was sent, as a messenger, specifically to Banī Issrāʿīl. The āyah says Ɛīssā came to them with بِٱلْبَيِّنَٰتِ. We've talked about بِٱلْبَيِّنَٰتِ "Bayyinat" before, they are the instruments that make things clear, the instruments of deduction, that allow you to extract things from the Qurʿān, or the techniques for extracting evidence from the scripture. The āyah then quotes Ɛīssā as saying: "I brought you "Al-Hikmah". This is how Allahh (SWA) clearly defined "Al-Hikmah" for us. We don't need to make it up. So "Al-Hikmah" is "the instruments of deduction, Al-Bayyinat". And to confirm this, Allahh (SWA) continues quoting Ɛīssā (AS). He says: *"to expose to you, in accordance with your ways, some of what you used to disagree about among yourselves. And thus, be disciplined in your seeking of Allahh, and obey me!"*

Therefore, this āyah is very clear that "Bayyinat" is a "Al-Hikmah". Notice that the verbs جَآءَ and جِئْتُكُم are the same exact verb, both used for the objects "Al Bayyinat" and "Al-Hikmah" respectively. So "Al-Hikmah" is "Al Bayyinat". This is the definition of "Al-Hikmah": It's the instruments of extracting evidence

from the scripture. As we said, many times, part of the methodology includes all of the "Bayyinat", all of the instruments of extracting evidence from the text itself.

Gift #3: What is the Primary Benefit of ٱلْحِكْمَةَ "Al-Ḥikmah"?

We already saw one very important benefit from 43:63:

وَلِأُبَيِّنَ لَكُم بَعْضَ ٱلَّذِى تَخْتَلِفُونَ فِيهِ

and to expose to you, in accordance with your ways, some of what you used to disagree about among yourselves

That's one of the benefits. What else? in Sūrah An Nisa (4:82), Allahh (SWA) explains to us what تَخْتَلِفُونَ means. What is this disagreement that Ɛīssā was talking about? The āyah says:

أَفَلَا يَتَدَبَّرُونَ ٱلْقُرْءَانَ وَلَوْ كَانَ مِنْ عِندِ غَيْرِ ٱللَّهِ لَوَجَدُوا فِيهِ ٱخْتِلَٰفًا كَثِيرًا ﴿4:82﴾ - النساء

Do they not then engage the Quran? And if it (i.e., the way of engaging the Qurʿān) is inspired by anyone other than Allah, they would certainly find in it (i.e., the invented way of their engagement) many disagreements about which to argue (among themselves).

I'm going to bring to your attention something we discussed a long time ago, which is the principle of relevance. Now, we have to slow down and really reflect. Watch this. Paying close attention to where the āyah says: *"…And if **it**…"* and also where it says: *"…they will certainly find **it**…"* The question becomes: What is the pronoun "it" referring to? Many scholars, interpreters and translators claimed that the pronoun "it" refers to the Qurʿān. Now, if we think about this a little bit, if "it" refers to the Qurʿān, that means Allahh (SWA) is subjecting whether or not the Qurʿān is deemed truthful, to the limited abilities of a creature called the human being. Think about this a little bit. If their interpretation is correct, Allahh (SWA) would mean that if you find any kind of disagreement within the Qurʿān, that means it's not from Allahh. Do you think Allahh would say this in the Qurʿān? Do you think this is even a rational, logical criterion that Allahh (SWA) would provide for us? Because if this was true, any non-Muslim can find a million excuses for claiming there are disagreements within the āyat of the Qurʿān. Of course, this is not the meaning. According to the relevance principle, this cannot be the meaning.

So, let's analyze it a little bit more. Allahh (SWA) is saying, *"let them engage the Qurʿān, using a method of some sort"* (Remember "Tadabbur"). And we say using the methodology. *"If this methodology, and their way of engaging the Qurʿān is inspired by anyone else other than Allahh, they would certainly find in it disagreements".* ٱخْتِلَٰفًا does not mean confusion or conflicts, it means disagreement among the people. Therefore, Allahh (SWA) is telling us (paraphrasing): "If you follow the methodology for 'Tadabbur' that I taught you in the Qur'an, you would not have disagreements among yourselves. If you follow a methodology for "Tadabbur" that is wrong, not sanctioned by Allahh, and not extracted from the Qurʿān,

you're going to end up with a situation where you have many disagreements among yourselves." It is not talking about inconsistencies in the Qurʿān, and neither is it talking about conflicts or contradictions. It is talking about the human beings, and how they end up being in conflict.

Now, I want you to reflect on this. Look around you within the state of the Muslim Ummah and ask yourself: Are we in agreements or are we in disagreements? That alone should tell you that this āyah applies to us? They did not do "Tadabbur" according to the way: مِنْ عِندِ ٱللَّهِ, they did it according to the way: مِنْ عِندِ غَيْرِ ٱللَّهِ. Why? They made up their own methodologies. If they used a methodology at all. They made up their own opinions, their own methods, techniques and ideas of how to deal with the Qurʿān. They decided for themselves how to use it, how to engage it, and how to extract evidence to create Halal and Haram rulings and fatwahs. All of this is manmade. Every single thing I talked about right now in the tradition is manmade. It is not extracted from the Qurʿān.

Allahh (SWA) is very clear. If you want to avoid disagreement among yourselves, make sure you do "Tadabbur" in accordance to the way Allahh (SWA) told you: مِنْ عِندِ ٱللَّهِ, not مِنْ عِندِ غَيْرِ ٱللَّهِ.

To prove this word ٱخْتِلَٰفًا does not mean inconsistencies, contradictions or discrepancies; But rather, ٱخْتِلَٰفًا in the Qurʿān consistently refers to disagreements (usually among misguided groups). **The letter "ت" clearly indicates "willfulness" and "intention"!** We repeat this all the time, whenever you see the letter "ت" entering into the morpheme of a verb or a noun, it refers to willfulness or intention. That means there was some ill will in the original interpretation or the original "Tadabbur", that would actually lead to the various disagreements.

Where did we see this before? We saw this in āyah number seven of Sūrah Ali 'Imran (3:7). If you remember, they were seeking to create "fitna" ٱبْتِغَآءَ ٱلْفِتْنَةِ "Seeking (to cause) tribulation." One of the ways they did this is to go carry some meanings or some stories from the corrupted versions of earlier scriptures, and impose them over the Qurʿān, and thus created "fitna", disagreements and divisions within the community, within the Muslim Ummah.

If you want to confirm this same understanding, I encourage you to look at this list of āyat:

See Aya **2:213,** 5:19, 5:55, 5:105, 10:19, 10:93, 19:37, etc.

All of these āyat confirm the exact same thing I'm talking about.

Gift #4: What is the Primary Benefit of ٱلْحِكْمَةَ "Al-Ḥikmah"? (continued)

One of the benefits of "Al-Hikmah" is to avoid the willful and intentional causes of disagreements, as we just saw. So, the purpose of "Al-Hikmah" is to avoid confirmation bias. In other words, if you want to avoid your own biases, your own leanings toward a certain predetermining result, and then seeking the evidence for it in the Qurʿān, you should employ a very clear methodology based on the instruments of extracting evidence, and that is called "Al-Hikmah". Therefore, "Al-Hikmah" is an essential part of the methodology.

In other words, imagine you're a Mason building a wall (This is the example we use all the time). So, you built it wrong, you built it leaning, and now you want to prove to the owner that the wall is acceptable, and it passes the contractual obligations. Even though you know that you did not use the right instruments. What do you do? You may use the wrong instruments to prove your point, and your instruments would confirm that it is correct, but it's because the instrument themselves are wrong.

"Al-Hikmah" from the Qur'an allows you to avoid your own bias, and allows you to be honest with yourself, to be objective, and to be disciplined. Therefore, if you make a mistake, the right knowledge about "Al-Hikmah" would prevent you from claiming that your mistake is actually correct. And this is very, very important. In Sūrah Al Baqarah (2:213), Allahh (SWA) confirms this:

.. وَمَا ٱخْتَلَفَ فِيهِ إِلَّا ٱلَّذِينَ أُوتُوهُ مِنۢ بَعْدِ مَا جَآءَتْهُمُ ٱلْبَيِّنَٰتُ بَغْيًۢا بَيْنَهُمْ فَهَدَى ٱللَّهُ ٱلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا لِمَا ٱخْتَلَفُوا فِيهِ مِنَ ٱلْحَقِّ بِإِذْنِهِ وَٱللَّهُ يَهْدِى مَن يَشَآءُ إِلَىٰ صِرَٰطٍ مُّسْتَقِيمٍ ﴿2:213﴾ - البقرة

Those who disagree about it (i.e., the scripture) are only those who were allowed to learn it as a result of receiving the instruments of deduction, and then (disagreed about it) only out of enmity against each other!
But Allahh guided, by his permission, those who attained to belief to what they disagreed about it when they diverged away from the truth, and Allahh guides to the self correcting methodology whoever wills to be guided!

In this case, this āyah is talking about those who disagreed about the scripture of Musa. Here, Allah is describing a people who were already deciding that they wanted certain conclusions to be reached, and they manufactured the evidence. They misrepresented "Al-Hikmah" that was given to them. So, they did not follow the right "Hikmah". They started with their pre-determined conclusions, and they sought the evidence to support their case. That is not "Al-Hikmah". That is the wrong application of knowledge. Allahh (SWA) gives us "Al-Hikmah" to start with a blank slate, with an empty cup, apply "Al-Hikmah", the instruments of extracting the evidence, and then let the evidence lead you where it may lead you, to the truth. If you are truly submitting to Allahh (SWA), and to the instruments of knowledge and evidence. You would follow the truth, wherever it may take you.

Gift #5: Wherefrom Do We Get ٱلْحِكْمَةَ "Al-Ḥikmah"?

Allahh (SWA) tells us in Sūrah Al Baqarah again, 2:69:

يُؤْتِى ٱلْحِكْمَةَ مَن يَشَآءُ وَمَن يُؤْتَ ٱلْحِكْمَةَ فَقَدْ أُوتِىَ خَيْرًا كَثِيرًا وَمَا يَذَّكَّرُ إِلَّآ أُو۟لُوا ٱلْأَلْبَٰبِ ﴿2:269﴾ - البقرة

To whomever he (Allahh) wills, he allows to learn Al-Ḥikmah (i.e., the instruments of deduction), and whomever is allowed to learn Al-Ḥikmah, such person has been allowed to learn copious amounts of correct applications. But none (may) seek to sow (new inquiries into his Weltanschauung) except those with guided cores.

Remember, خَيْرًا does not simply mean a vanilla flavored “good” or “good things”. No, it's a very specific and precise term that is part of the Abrahamic locution. It refers to the correct applications of what you learn. And again, we continuously see the same verb: يَذَّكَّرُ repeating again and again, in relationship to knowledge, evidence, and to instruments of extracting evidence. All of those things are related, and they're part of the methodology. The methodology says: you look at the text, you develop some questions that you have about the text, and you let them stew. You let them sit unanswered, submitting patiently, and waiting for Allahh (SWA) to guide you. Don't make up your mind in a hurry, and don't allow yourself to predetermine what conclusions you want to reach. Let Allahh (SWA) guide you, and trust Allahh. That's the submission that we're talking about.

If you remember, the answers come from the “Samaawaat”, and the “Samaawaat” are not in the text, and thus, the understanding is not in the text. The understanding comes real time, live from Allahh directly to you. If you have implemented the right methodology, you have been self-correcting all the way through, and prevented yourself from preconceived notions, confirmation bias, discrimination, and from whatever wishful thinking you want to reach. If you've helped yourself avoid these things, Allahh (SWA) will reward you with the right answer, and the right understanding. And then you proceed with the methodology to validate this understanding, and then to verify if it makes sense in light of everything else we know about the Qurʿān. And you work through the process diligently, step-by-step, and allow it to take as much time as it would, but that's the process. That's the methodology. And with that, insha Allahh, you would reach the peacefulness, the Sakina, and the pleasure of knowing you are living in Jannat.

And with this, we come to the conclusion of this segment, which is the interpretation of āyah 3:7. As you have seen, it's a very loaded segment. It has a lot of information, and I hope you've been with us all through this segment because the best is yet to come.

Final Conclusion: This interpretation of aya 3:7 proves:

- Aya 3:7 has been interpreted in Tafseer books to indicate the exact opposite of what it was supposed to indicate: Their interpretation violates the clear āyat of the Qurʿān!

  So, they use that āyah to tell us that some of the āyat are muhkamat, and some of them are imprecise, confusing, not clear, ambiguous, etc. Whereas, Allahh (SWA) is telling us clearly that some of these are the mother of the book, they're the Umm-ul Kitaab, the Foundry, the source of semantics. They're the basis, the solid ground upon which you stand to create new understanding. Other āyat are Mutashābih because they look like other sources outside the Qurʿān. And then those who want to have the other sources, Allahh (SWA) described them as having diplopia in their cores, hearts, and in their understanding. And therefore, it's the exact opposite of what they taught us in the books of Tafseer. Their interpretation violates the clear āyat of the Qurʿān. They said that some of the āyat are Muḥkam. Whereas as clearly, as we saw in Sūrah Hud, all of the āyat of the scripture, all of the āyat of the Quran are precisely crafted to provide clear semantics. So therefore, it's the exact opposite of what they told us in the books of tafseer.
- Their interpretation neglects the important methodological instruction included in this āyah 3:7

- Their interpretation served to ignore the admonition against subjecting the Qurʿān to interpretations brought from corrupted versions of earlier scriptures

  Āyah 3:7 tells us not to do this, yet that's exactly what they did. How did they succeed in doing it? By corrupting the interpretation of āyah 3:7. I'm really sorry if I seem to be so critical, but this is a foundational āyah. This is an āyah that is at the heart of the methodology and at the heart of understanding the very nature of the Qurʿān. They doubted the fact that all āyat of the Qurʿān are 'Muḥkamat', precisely crafted. Therefore, they belied the truthfulness of the Qurʿān. The Qurʿān in Sūrah Hud, āyah number one, clearly tells us all of the āyah are 'Muḥkamat', but they refused that. They didn't want that. How did they do this? By corrupting the interpretation of 3:7.

- Their interpretation was used to prevent people from seeking to do tadabbur on the Qurʿān

  They insist some āyat are 'Mutashābihat', and they say: "You should not mess with them. You should leave them alone, and not dive into them. They're not for you to do tadabbur. Allahh (SWA) knows what their real meaning is." And you see a lot of the comments in the comment stream telling me to avoid getting into quote 'Mutashābihat'. Why? Because they were taught this wrong interpretation.

- Their interpretation was used to attack those who offer interpretations that reject the mythology and the absurd stories that fill the books of Tafseer.

  Anytime anyone comes up with a better interpretation, based on some clear, significant discoveries from the vocabulary of the Qurʿān, they attack him. They attack that person saying: "you are getting into 'Mutashābihat', so you're a bad person. You are a person in whose core there is diplopia (زَيْغٌ)," and so on. They attack this person, even though that person is really trying to seek a better representation of the Qurʿān. They insist on seeing things double. They insist on bringing the stories from the corrupted versions of the earlier scriptures, and teaching those stories as if they were the Qurʿān. So, it's absolutely reversing the truth. Turning black into white, and white into black. Turning things into the opposite of what they should be.

- This āyah actually reveals the true intentions of those who abused the divine lexicon!

- MOST IMPORTANTLY: IT PREVENTED MUSLIMS FROM SUPPLICATING IN ACCORDDANCE WITH THE INSTRUCTIONS OF THE QURAN!

  Because of the wrong interpretation of this āyah, we were not allowed to get into the concepts of Al-Ḥukm, and Al-Asmaa'ul Hussna. Therefore, their wrong interpretation of this āyah prevented countless number of Muslims, to this day, from supplicating and doing Du£āʿ in accordance with the instructions, Al-Ḥukm, and the divine vocabulary and lexicon of the Qurʿān. Therefore you, my friend, my brother or my sister have been suffering the wrong method of creating Du£āʿ, or making supplication because of their misrepresentation of āyah 3:7. I hope this is clear and I hope this is causing you to really reflect, because this is a significant conclusion. And this is significant proof that I've just shared with you, I hope, through this segment.

In case you are keeping track:

1. We have annulled a bogus so-called "3ilm" called "The Abrogator and the Abrogated" (An-Nạsikh Wal-Mansūkh), **النَّاسِخ وَالمَنْسُوخ** (Does God sit on a throne?)

   We prove to you that they did not understand the verb Nasakah, according to the Abrahamic locution, and because of that, they created all sorts of problems. They were so arrogant to claim that some āyat of the Qurʿān were annulled, and you can throw them away. Even though they're still in the scripture, they don't mean anything to us, and we should not take them into consideration. We should not understand them as if they're real. They're just there because somebody forgot to take them out. This is literally what the abrogation means according to them. It means these āyat were annulled and canceled, but they were not removed from the texts. I don't know what audacity that got them to say this. I have no idea how they got the heart to get these words out of their mouths.
   We showed in the video segment: "does God sit on a throne?" that there is a totally different meaning to the word Nasakah. And it's a beautiful indication. It's a very spiritual, supportive, really relieving type of understanding where Allahh (SWA) is taking care of you. If you make a mistake, he will provide the support for you to correct those mistakes in your Weltanschauung if you trust him, submit to him, and you really understand the beauty of seeking direct guidance from Allahh (SWA) alone. If on the other hand, you take intermediaries, other human beings who tell you what you should believe, and what the vocabulary means, then you're left misguided. You're left deluded and confused, and you're left not trusting this beautiful gift to mankind. Allahh (SWA) gave us this book, and taught us how to best use it. They refused, they just pushed it aside, and invented something called a "An-Nạsikh Wal-Mansūkh".

2. We have also annulled another bogus so-called "3ilm" called "Occasions of Revelation" (Asbāb-un Nuzūl), **أسبابُ النُّزُول** (in the segment titled "What is the coming promise mentioned in Surah Abasa (ch. 80) - Is it about you? - Part 4")

   We demonstrated that there was another pseudo 3ilm called "Occasions of Revelation" (Asbāb-un Nuzūl). We also proved that their claims about this "3ilm" are bogus, irrelevant, wrong and erroneous. They don't apply to the Qurʿān, and they have nothing to do with the Qurʿān. Yes, there might be reasons why they thought the āyah was revealed, but the actual content of the āyah has nothing to do with the temporality of a single event. We proved that beyond the shadow of the doubt, when we discussed the story of "Abasa watawalla"

3. In this segment, we demonstrated the futility of another so-called "3ilm", "Al-Muḥkam wal-Mutashābih". This is a totally made up pseudo-3ilm without any Qurʿānic basis: Not sanctioned by the Prophet (PBUH) or any of his close companions.

   This "3ilm" is absolutely useless. And incidentally, when you talk to any scholar, from any university, or any Institute of Islamic education, and ask him to define Muḥkam or Mutashābih,

you don't find two scholars that have the exact same definition. Every single one of them disagree about the definition of Muhkam and Mutashabih. Therefore, it is the most obvious disagreement. It is the most obvious cause for them to pause and think, and admit that they got it wrong and should revisit it. And as you saw, we gave a beautiful interpretation of āyah 3:7, which is the basis for this so-called “3ilm”, that totally eliminates any ambiguity in this āyah. And thus, we prove that this is a totally made up pseudo 3ilm without any Qurʿānic basis. They have no reason to claim it. It was never sanctioned by the prophet (SAW), and it was never sanctioned, in a reliable way, by any of the close companions of our beloved (SAW).

So, as you see, we keep unraveling the “Hur” from the Qurʿān. And by unraveling the “Hur” from the Qurʿān, we discovered the beautiful jewels, and the beautiful, clear guidance from Allahh (SWA). I asked Allahh (SWA) that you have benefited from this discussion, and this segment.

If you find that you have benefited from this segment and you stayed with us all the way through, I would really appreciate it if you would subscribe. If you're already a subscriber, please click the red bell button to receive immediate notifications whenever we release something new. And please like, and comment in a respectful way. Hopefully you will have significant questions that we can engage as adult learners, communicating with each other, and learning from each other insha Allahh.

And now we come to the end of the segment and we close with the DuƐāʿ that we always use to close with.

الْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ الَّذِیْ هَدٰىنَا لِهٰذَا ۫ وَ مَا كُنَّا لِنَهْتَدِیَ لَوْ لَاۤ اَنْ هَدٰىنَا اللّٰهُ ۚ لَقَدْ جَآءَتْ رُسُلُ رَبِّنَا بِالْحَقِّ

I thank you very much for watching. Salaamun Alaykum.